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Graduate Recruitment Team

Howden

One Creechurch Place

London EC3A 5AF

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Private Capital Portfolio Solutions Graduate Programme (2027 intake) in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Howden Private Capital is a newly established global division serving private equity, private credit and infrastructure investors, and joining a team while it is still being built appeals to me as someone who co-founded a society from nothing.

My preparation for investing has come from taking deals apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, breaking down why the buyer wanted the asset, how the deal was structured and how the stake was valued. My strongest academic results reflect the same interest: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

Private equity appeals to me because the investor owns the outcome: the thesis has to be delivered after the deal closes, not just argued before it. I have seen that side at a small scale. As Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, I created its house cocktails, set the specifications for its classics and trained around 15 bar staff to deliver them from launch. Before that, at KONG, I analysed sales patterns and refined our upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%. Both roles taught me that value is created in execution: in standards, training and small commercial decisions that compound.

Howden Private Capital stands out to me because it approaches private capital from the risk side, helping investors and portfolio companies manage risk as well as grow, and because it is newly established, so graduates join while its offering to sponsors is still taking shape. Building the Agricapital Society from launch to 126 members taught me how much a young organisation depends on people who will research, analyse and take ownership, and my sessions on deals such as Olam Agri's sale to SALIC have given me a working understanding of how private investors assess and protect value.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan